



viewer is shown a montage that contradicts his words. He is seen working his way up from rock bottom as a musical performer, as he and his partner Cosmo Brown (Donald O'Connor) perform in dive bars, get booed off the stage, and stand in the unemployment line. The second story takes place within the extended fantasy sequence "Broadway Melody," in which Don arrives on Broadway as an eager

performer and is then corrupted by fame and adulation, before eventually rediscovering why he wanted to sing and dance in the first place. The final story is that of the movie itself, in which Don evolves from a silent star to his true vocation as a musical performer.

The movie uses these stories to examine just what it is that constitutes artistic success. It is not the same as simply making it, and getting rich—it is about the artist doing what he or she loves without compromise. Don is a

Actress Cyd Charisse as herself is Kelly's sensational dance partner in the "Broadway Melody" musical sequence.

movie star from the moment we meet him, yet he is not truly successful until the last scene, when he is in his element, having become a musical star instead of a silent actor, and is with the girl he loves, Kathy Selden (Debbie Reynolds), instead of the self-serving Lina. The movie takes an optimistic view, suggesting that the path to finding your creative self is long and difficult, but if you have the talent and conviction, as Don does, you'll eventually get to where you belong.

Singin' in the Rain stands out in the pantheon of musicals for a number of reasons. It takes a self-deprecating look at its own craft, and it features several iconic musical numbers (from the titular *Singin' in the Rain* to the comedic *Make 'em Laugh*), but above all it has endured because it speaks to a timeless fascination: the celebration and power of talent. While many movies portray the eventual corruption of talent and creative ambition, *Singin' in the Rain* salutes genuine talent as an irrepressible force that will always prevail. ■

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One of this movie's pleasures is that it's really about something. Of course it's about romance, as most musicals are, but it's also about the film industry in a period of dangerous transition.

Roger Ebert

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Gene Kelly Actor

Gene Kelly was born in 1912 in Pittsburgh, PA, and became a dance teacher

before making it to Broadway. His big break came in 1940 when he got the lead role in Rodgers and Hart's show, *Pal Joey*. *Anchors Aweigh* gave Kelly his first and last Oscar nomination for best actor, although *An American in Paris*, which Kelly

starred in, won several Oscars, including Best Picture. *Singin' in the Rain* was a modest success upon release, but its popularity soon grew. Kelly died in 1996.

Key movies

1945 *Anchors Aweigh*

1946 *Ziegfeld Follies*

1951 *An American in Paris*

1952 *Singin' in the Rain*

1960 *Inherit the Wind*